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VEHICLE ENCOUNTER GUIDE

What to do if ICE stops your car • Qué hacer si ICE detiene su auto

KEEP THIS IN YOUR CAR. ICE is increasingly stopping vehicles using unmarked cars and Automated License Plate Readers (ALPRs). Know your rights before an encounter happens.

DO

- ✓ Pull over safely, turn off engine
- ✓ Keep hands visible on steering wheel
- ✓ Ask: "Are you police or immigration?"
- ✓ Provide license & registration (drivers)
- ✓ Stay calm and polite
- ✓ Crack window only — do not fully open
- ✓ Record if safe (or have passenger record)

DON'T

- ✗ Don't answer questions about immigration status
- ✗ Don't say where you were born
- ✗ Don't consent to a search
- ✗ Don't sign anything without a lawyer
- ✗ Don't run or resist physically
- ✗ Don't lie or give false documents
- ✗ Don't open door or exit unless ordered

WHAT TO SAY • QUÉ DECIR

"Are you from immigration or the police?"

"¿Es usted de inmigración o de la policía?"

"I am exercising my right to remain silent."

"Estoy ejerciendo mi derecho a permanecer en silencio."

"I do not consent to a search."

"No doy mi consentimiento para un registro."

"Am I free to leave?"

"¿Soy libre de irme?"

"I want to speak to a lawyer."

"Quiero hablar con un abogado."

DRIVERS VS. PASSENGERS • CONDUCTORES VS. PASAJEROS

DRIVERS must:

- Show driver's license
- Show vehicle registration
- Show proof of insurance

But do NOT have to answer questions about immigration status or birthplace.

PASSENGERS have NO obligation to:

- Show any identification
- Give their name
- Answer any questions

Passengers can remain completely silent. Say: "I am exercising my right to remain silent."

STEP-BY-STEP: IF ICE STOPS YOUR VEHICLE

PASO A PASO: SI ICE DETIENE SU VEHÍCULO

1. PULL OVER SAFELY

Turn off the engine. Keep your hands visible on the steering wheel. Do not reach for documents until asked.

Apague el motor. Mantenga sus manos visibles en el volante. No busque documentos hasta que se lo pidan.

2. IDENTIFY THE OFFICERS

ICE often uses unmarked cars and may say "police." Ask: "Are you from immigration or the police?" and "What agency are you from?"

ICE a menudo usa autos sin identificar y puede decir "policía." Pregunte: "¿Es usted de inmigración o de la policía?" y "¿De qué agencia es?"

3. CRACK THE WINDOW ONLY

Open your window only enough to pass documents. A fully open window allows officers to reach inside, open the door, or pull you out.

Abra su ventana solo lo suficiente para pasar documentos. Una ventana completamente abierta permite que los oficiales alcancen adentro.

4. PROVIDE REQUIRED DOCUMENTS (DRIVERS ONLY)

Hand over your driver's license, registration, and insurance. Do NOT provide a passport, consular ID, or any foreign documents.

Entregue su licencia de conducir, registro y seguro. NO proporcione pasaporte, identificación consular ni documentos extranjeros.

5. EXERCISE YOUR RIGHT TO REMAIN SILENT

You do not have to answer questions about where you were born, your immigration status, or where you are going. Say: "I am exercising my right to remain silent."

No tiene que responder preguntas sobre dónde nació, su estatus migratorio o a dónde va. Diga: "Estoy ejerciendo mi derecho a permanecer en silencio."

6. DO NOT CONSENT TO A SEARCH

ICE cannot search your car without a judicial warrant, probable cause, or your consent. Clearly state: "I do not consent to a search." They may search anyway—do not physically resist, but repeat that you do not consent.

ICE no puede registrar su auto sin una orden judicial, causa probable o su consentimiento. Diga claramente: "No doy mi consentimiento para un registro."

7. IF ORDERED TO EXIT

Ask: "Am I required to get out?" If they insist, comply slowly with hands visible. Lock the car behind you. You may be arrested when you exit—before getting out, ask for the reason for the stop.

Pregunte: "¿Estoy obligado a salir?" Si insisten, cumpla lentamente con las manos visibles. Cierre el auto con llave detrás de usted.

8. IF ARRESTED

Say: "I want to speak to a lawyer. I am exercising my right to remain silent." Do not sign anything. Memorize your emergency contact's number. You have the right to a phone call.

Diga: "Quiero hablar con un abogado. Estoy ejerciendo mi derecho a permanecer en silencio." No firme nada. Tiene derecho a una llamada telefónica.

■ **SAFETY FIRST:** ICE officers are armed. Even if you believe your rights are being violated, remain calm and do not physically resist. Document everything afterward and contact a lawyer.

EMERGENCY CONTACTS • CONTACTOS DE EMERGENCIA

ICE Detainee Locator:	locator.ice.gov
EOIR Case Status:	1-800-898-7180
Freedom for Immigrants:	9233# from detention
ICIRR (Illinois):	1-855-435-7693
National Crisis Line:	988

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This guide provides general legal information, not legal advice. For advice about your specific situation, consult a qualified immigration attorney. Esta guía proporciona información legal general, no asesoramiento legal. Para consejos sobre su situación específica, consulte a un abogado de inmigración calificado.

Last updated: January 2026 • Keep this guide in your glove compartment